

The PA's First-Day Card

Everything from "Your First Day as a PA" on one page. Fold it into your back pocket.

BEFORE CALL

- Your call time is on **your line** of the call sheet. PAs are often earlier than general crew call.
- Arrive 15 minutes early. Early is on time.
- Find the **nearest hospital** on the sheet before you need it.
- Sign in with the key PA and ask where they want you.

THE LOCKUP

When someone wants through while you're rolling:

"We're rolling right now. It'll be about a minute. Thanks so much for waiting."

- A lockup is a request. **Never touch anyone.**
- Echo "rolling" and "cut" on the radio.
- Let them through on "cut", and thank them.

SAFETY: CALL IT FIRST

- Anyone on set can call a hold for safety. **Call it, then fix it.**
- On channel 1: "Hold the roll, [what and where]."
- A lost minute is cheap. An injury stops the shoot.
- After a near miss, tell the truth fast.

RADIO

Go for [name]	How you answer when called
Copy	I heard and understood
Flying in	On my way
Go to 2	Switch channels for a longer talk
What's your 20?	Where are you?
10-1	Bathroom break

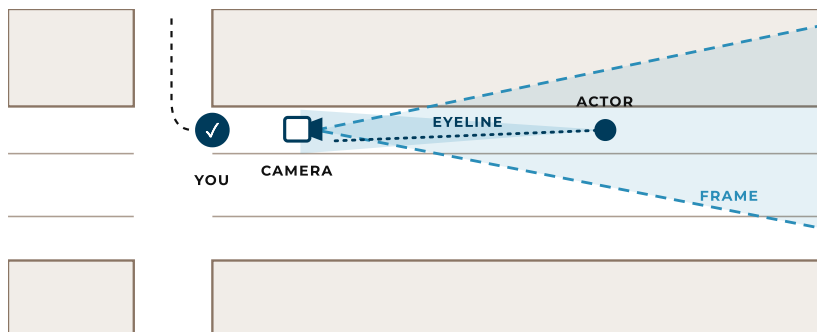
Channel 1 is production. Keep it to one sentence.

WHO YOU WORK FOR

- You work for the **ADs**. Take direction from the 2nd AD and the key PA.
- Other departments' gear is theirs. Don't touch it unless they ask and show you how.
- Messages for the director go **through the ADs**.
- Made a mistake? Own it in one sentence and say what you'll do next time.

BEFORE YOU LEAVE

- ☐ Walkie and earpiece back to the key PA
- ☐ Cones and signs picked up from your post
- ☐ Tomorrow's call sheet in hand
- ☐ Signed out with the key PA



WHERE TO STAND

- **Out of frame:** if you can see the lens, it may see you.
- **Out of the eyeline:** never where the actor looks, and don't watch them during a take.
- **Eyes on the approach,** so you see people before they reach the shot.
- Not sure? Ask "Am I clear?"